Stellenbosch 5v5 Ultimate Frisbee Rules (Summary)

Based off:
WFDF Rules of Ultimate 2025-2028

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Introduction

Stellenbosch Ultimate Frisbee League in a 5v5 format is a fast-paced, non-contact team sport that combines elements of rugby sevens and netball. Two teams of 5 players compete on a field, passing the disc to advance toward the opposing team's end zone to score points. Like in netball, you cannot run while holding the disc—you must stop and pass to a teammate. Similar to rugby sevens, the game is continuous, meaning possession quickly switches between offence and defence when a pass is dropped, intercepted, or goes out of bounds.

This format emphasizes quick decision-making, teamwork, agility, and endurance. The game encourages spatial awareness, strategic movement, and accurate throws rather than physical contact, making it accessible and fun for all skill levels. It is played on a rectangular field, 25m wide and 65m long. Games are typically played to 15 goals or around 45 minutes.

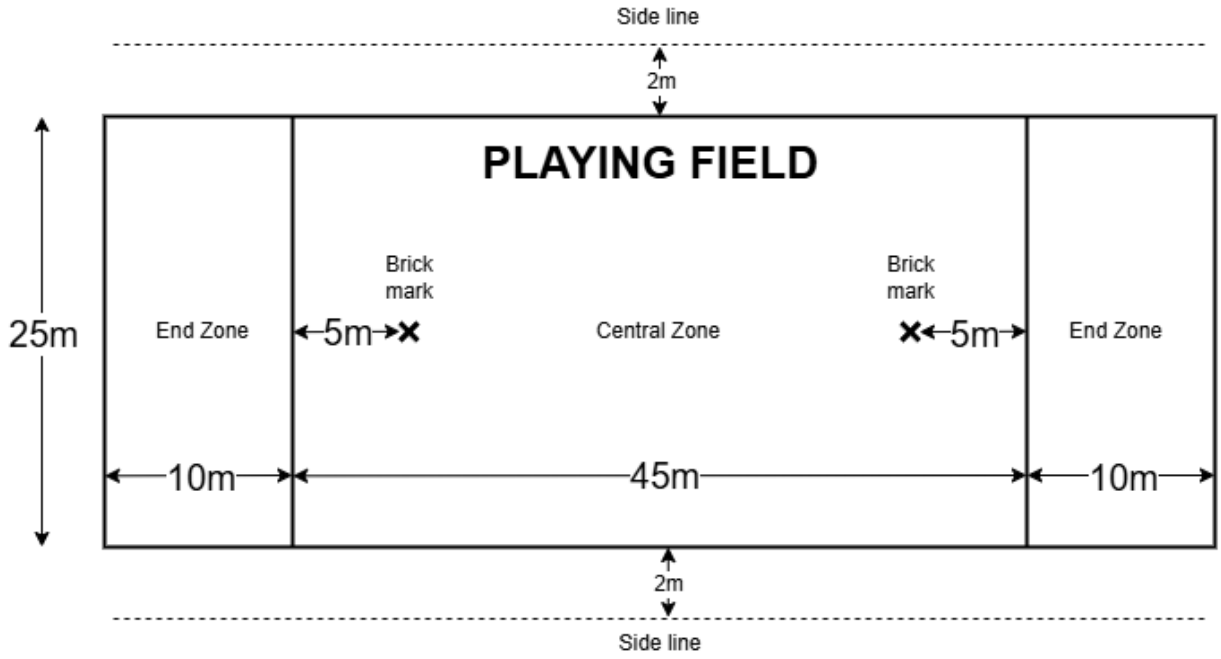
Whether you're new to disc sports or have experience in netball or rugby, you'll find 5v5 Ultimate exciting and easy to pick up!

1. Spirit of the Game

1.1. Highly competitive play is encouraged, but should never sacrifice the mutual respect between players, adherence to the agreed-upon rules of the game, player safety or the basic joy of play.

1.2. In the case where a novice player is involved in a breach and does not know the rules, experienced players should assist to explain the breach.

2. Playing Field



3. Equipment

3.1. Each player must wear kit that represents their team.

3.2. Shoes: Flat soled or barefoot. **NO CLEATS**.

4. Game

4.1. Games consist of two halves of 20 minutes with a 5 minute half time.

4.2. A game is finished and won by the first team to score fifteen (15) goals.

4.2.1. At time cap if neither team has reached fifteen (15) goals, +1 to the highest score, that becomes the new match target. The game continues until a team wins by reaching the time cap target.

4.3. Any player may attempt to stop a disc from rolling or sliding after it has hit the ground.

4.4. If after discussion players cannot agree, or it is not clear and obvious the disc must be returned to the last non-disputed thrower.

5. Teams

5.1. Each team will put a maximum of five (5) players and a minimum of four (4) players on the field during each point.

5.2. A team may consist of a maximum of fifteen (15) players.

5.3. A team may make unlimited substitutions after a goal is scored and before their team signals readiness for the pull.

6. Starting a Game

6.1. Representatives of the two teams fairly determine (from a disc flip) which team first chooses either:

6.1.1. Whether to receive or throw the initial pull; or

6.1.2. Which end zone they will initially defend.

6.2. The other team is given the remaining choice.

6.3. At the start of the second half, these initial selections are switched.

7. The Pull

7.1. No player on the defensive team may touch the disc after a pull until a member of the offensive team contacts the disc or the disc hits the ground.

7.2. If the disc initially contacts the playing field and never becomes out-of-bounds, the thrower must establish a pivot point where the disc stops, even if that pivot point is in their defending end zone.

7.3. If the disc contacts the out-of-bounds area without first touching the playing field or an offensive player, the thrower may establish a pivot point either at the brick mark closest to their defending end zone, or at the location on the central zone closest to where the disc went out-of-bounds the binding brick option must be signalled before the disc is picked up. It must be signalled by any offensive player fully extending one arm overhead, and they should call "**brick**".

8. Out-of-Bounds

8.1. The perimeter lines are not part of the playing field and are out-of-bounds.

8.2. An airborne player retains their in-bounds/out-of-bounds status until that player contacts the playing field or the out-of-bounds area.

8.3. A player who has caught the disc, who contacts the playing field and then contacts an out-of- bounds area, is still considered in-bounds, as long as they maintain the catch until they establish possession.

8.4. If they leave the playing field, they must establish a pivot point at the location on the playing field where they crossed the perimeter line.

9. Receivers and Positioning

9.1. A "catch" occurs when a player has a non-spinning disc trapped between at least two body parts. A catch can enable a player to establish possession of the disc.

9.2. If offensive and defensive players catch the disc simultaneously, the offence retains possession.

9.3. Some minor contact may occur as two or more players move towards a single point simultaneously. Minor contact should be minimized but is not considered a foul.

9.4. Players may not use their extended arms or legs to obstruct the movement of opposing players.

10. Turnovers

10.1. During the pull, the offence touches the disc before it hits the ground and subsequently fails to establish possession of the disc (a "**dropped pull**").

10.2. A turnover that transfers possession of the disc from one team to the other, and results in a stoppage of play, occurs when:

10.2.1. The thrower has not released the pass before the marker first starts to say the word "ten" in the stall count (a "**stall-out**");

10.2.2. The disc is intentionally transferred from one offensive player to another without ever being Completely untouched by both players (a "**handover**");

10.3. If the turnover location is in the offence's attacking end zone, the thrower must establish a pivot point at the nearest location on the goal line.

11. Stall Count

11.1. The marker administers a stall count on the thrower by announcing "Stalling" and then counting from One (1) to ten (10). The interval between the start of each number in the stall count must be at least one (1) second.

11.2. **The stall count must be verbally and clearly communicated to the thrower.**

12. The Check

12.1. To restart play with a check when the thrower has the disc:
- 12.1.1. If there is a defender within reach, the defender must touch the disc.
- 12.1.2. If there is not a defender within reach, the thrower must touch the disc to the ground and may call "**Disc In**".

12.2. A player may call a violation regarding the check if an opponent attempts a pass without an appropriate check.

13. Calling Fouls, Infractions and Violations

13.1. Only the player fouled may claim a foul, by calling "**Foul**".

13.2. If the player against whom the foul, infraction or violation has been called disagrees that it occurred, or does not think it is a correct call, they may call "**Contest**".

13.3. If a player making any call subsequently determines that their call was incorrect, they can retract the call, by calling "**Retracted**". Play resumes as if an accepted breach has been caused by that player.

14. Stoppages

14.1. **Injury Stoppage:** An injury stoppage, "**Injury**", may be called by the injured player, or by any player on the injured player's team.

14.2. **Technical Stoppage:** If a player is substituted after an injury, or due to illegal or faulty equipment, the opposing team may also choose to substitute one player.

15. Time-Outs

15.1. Each team has **one** time out per match.

15.2. Only the player with the disk may call the time-out.

15.3. The player calling a time-out must form a "T" with their hands, or with one hand and the disc, and should call "**time-out**" to opposition players.

15.4. A timeout lasts **ninety (90) seconds**

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Rules of Ultimate - Hand Signals